

Participant Information Letter

Improving LLM-Based Concept Linking for Oral History Segments Using the WO2 Thesaurus Knowledge Graph

Dear participant,

You are invited to take part in an expert evaluation for a bachelor thesis project at Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam.

Before you decide whether you would like to participate, please read this information letter carefully. It explains the purpose of the study, what participation involves, how your data will be used, and what your rights are as a participant.

Purpose of the study

This bachelor thesis investigates whether retrieval from the WO2 Thesaurus knowledge graph can improve the correctness and specificity of LLM-based concept linking for oral history segments.

In this study, concept linking means assigning relevant thesaurus concepts to short segments from oral history interviews. The expert evaluation is used to assess whether the proposed concepts are correct and whether they are specific enough for the segment.

Why you are invited

You are invited because of your expertise in the Second World War, oral history, archival materials, thesauri, or related historical collections.

What participation involves

If you agree to participate, you will be asked to review a small set of short oral history excerpts. For each excerpt, you will see a list of proposed thesaurus concepts.

You will be asked to rate each proposed concept on two dimensions:

Correctness

You will indicate whether the concept is incorrect, partially correct, correct, or whether you are unsure.

Specificity

You will indicate whether the concept is too broad, appropriate, too narrow, not applicable, or whether you are unsure.

You may also add optional comments if you think an important concept is missing, if a concept label is unclear, or if you want to explain your judgment.

The concepts will be shown in one combined list. You will not be told which method produced which concept.

Expected time investment

The task is expected to take approximately 30-50 minutes.

Voluntary participation

Your participation is completely voluntary. You are free to decide not to participate. You may also stop participating at any time, without giving a reason.

Possible risks or discomfort

There are no expected physical or direct personal risks. However, the excerpts come from oral history interviews about the Second World War and may contain historically sensitive or emotionally difficult topics.

Data collected

The expert evaluation questionnaire collects your ratings of the proposed concepts and any optional comments you provide.

The questionnaire itself does not ask for your name, email address, signature, or other identifying details.

The only identifying information collected is your name, signature, and date on the informed consent form. This information is collected only to document your consent to participate. The signed consent form will be stored separately from the questionnaire responses and will not be used in the analysis or reported in the thesis.

Confidentiality and anonymity

Your questionnaire responses will be treated confidentially. The results of the expert evaluation will be reported anonymously in the bachelor thesis. Individual experts will not be named in the thesis.

Signed consent forms will be stored separately from the questionnaire responses.

Data storage

The collected questionnaire responses will be stored securely and will only be used for the purposes of this bachelor thesis and related academic assessment. The data will be retained according to the applicable VU data management and privacy requirements.

Use of the results

The results of the expert evaluation will be used to compare the concept-linking outputs of different methods. The findings may be included in the bachelor thesis in summarized and anonymized form.

Questions

If you have any questions about the study, you can contact:

Executive investigator: Feruza Bakhtiyorova

Email: f.bakhtiyorova@student.vu.nl

Responsible researcher / supervisor: Victor de Boer

Email: v.de.boer@vu.nl

Consent

If you decide to participate, you will be asked to sign the informed consent form. Please only sign the consent form if you have read this information letter and had the opportunity to ask questions.